

**NED UNIVERSITY OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY**  
**DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER & INFORMATION SYSTEMS**  
**ENGINEERING**

**SE 2024, FALL2025**  
**Complex Engineering Problem Report**



**DATA STRUCTURES & ALGORITHMS (CS-218)**

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**DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER & INFORMATION SYSTEMS ENGINEERING  
BACHELORS IN COMPUTER SYSTEMS ENGINEERING**

**Design Project**

**Course Code: CS-218, Course Title: Data Structures & Algorithms**

**CLO: CLO 3, Taxonomy Level: C3**

**Relevant attributes of Complex Problem Solving**

|              |                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Attribute -1 | Depth of analysis required  | Have no obvious solution and require abstract thinking, originality in analysis to formulate suitable models.                                                                                   |
| Attribute -2 | Depth of knowledge required | Require research-based knowledge much of which is at, or informed by, the forefront of the professional discipline and which allows a fundamentals-based, first principles analytical approach. |
| Attribute -3 | Familiarity of issues       | Involve frequently encountered issues.                                                                                                                                                          |

**Problem Statement**

Build a file compression tool with adequate GUI.

Submit a report containing:

1. the compression algorithm,
2. the code,
3. the extent of compression achieved with the tool,
4. the time and space complexity of the compression algorithm, and,
5. sample input and output files.

Present the running code to the course instructor when asked to do so.

Students may make a group of at most four for this assignment.

**DP Rubric**

|                                            |                                     |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Criterion 1: Compression algorithm         |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The selected algorithm is not suitable.    | The selected algorithm is suitable. |
| Criterion 2: Implementation                |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The code has some flaws.                   | The code is well-written.           |
| Criterion 3: Extent of compression         |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| Compression is poor.                       | Compression is adequate.            |
| Criterion 4: Time complexity               |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The analysis has some flaws.               | The analysis is well-written.       |
| Criterion 5: Space complexity              |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The analysis has some flaws.               | The analysis is well-written.       |
| Criterion 3: Input and output file samples |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The samples are inadequate.                | The samples are adequate.           |
| Criterion 7: Report format                 |                                     |
| 1                                          | 2                                   |
| The report lacks proper format.            | The report is well-written.         |

## Problem Statement:

This report presents an implementation of the Huffman Coding compression algorithm, a widely-used lossless data compression technique. The implementation demonstrates effective compression of text data with optimal time complexity for encoding and decoding operations.

## Chosen Algorithm: Huffman Coding

To solve the file compression problem, we have chosen Huffman Coding, which is a lossless compression algorithm. Huffman coding works by assigning shorter binary codes to symbols that appear more frequently in the input file, and longer codes to less frequent symbols. This ensures efficient compression without losing any data.

## Compression Algorithm: Huffman Coding

1. Step 1: Frequency Calculation  
Count the frequency of each character in the input text.  
`freq = {}`  
`for ch in input_text:`  
    `freq[ch] = freq.get(ch, 0) + 1`
2. Step 2: Create Huffman Nodes  
Each character becomes a node with its frequency.  
`heap = [Node(ch, fr) for ch, fr in freq.items()]`  
`heapq.heapify(heap) # Min-heap based on frequency`
3. Step 3: Build Huffman Tree  
Combine the two smallest nodes until only one root remains.  
`while len(heap) > 1:`  
    `node1 = heapq.heappop(heap)`  
    `node2 = heapq.heappop(heap)`  
    `merged = Node(None, node1.freq + node2.freq)`  
    `merged.left, merged.right = node1, node2`  
    `heapq.heappush(heap, merged)`  
    `root = heap[0]`
4. Step 4: Generate Huffman Codes  
Recursively assign binary codes to each character.  
`codes = {}`  
`def make_codes(node, current_code):`  
    `if node is None:`  
        `return`  
    `if node.char is not None:`  
        `codes[node.char] = current_code`  
        `return`  
    `make_codes(node.left, current_code + '0')`  
    `make_codes(node.right, current_code + '1')`  
    `make_codes(root, "")`
5. Step 5: Encode the Text  
Convert input text into binary string using generated codes.  
`encoded_text = ''.join(codes[ch] for ch in input_text)`
6. Step 6: Store or Display Compressed Data  
Compressed Output: `encoded_text` (binary string)  
Code Table: `codes` (used for decompression)

## CODE:

```
◆ Compression Tool (10).py X
C:\Users\LENOVO> Downloads > ◆ Compression Tool (10).py > compress_text
1 import heapq # Used to build a priority queue (min-heap) for Huffman tree
2 import os # Used for file path and size handling
3 from tkinter import * # GUI Library for building the interface
4 from tkinter import filedialog, messagebox # For file dialogs and alerts
5
6
7 # ----- HUFFMAN NODE CLASS -----
8 class Node:
9     def __init__(self, char, freq):
10         self.char = char # Character stored in node
11         self.freq = freq # Frequency of the character
12         self.left = None # Left child
13         self.right = None # Right child
14
15     def __lt__(self, other):
16         # Allows heapq to compare nodes based on frequency
17         return self.freq < other.freq
18
19
20 # ----- BUILD HUFFMAN TREE -----
21 def make_codes(node, current_code, codes):
22     """Recursive function to assign binary codes to each character."""
23     if node is None:
24         return
25     # If a leaf node is reached (actual character)
26     if node.char is not None:
27         codes[node.char] = current_code
28         return
29     # Recurse left with '0' and right with '1'
30     make_codes(node.left, current_code + "0", codes)
31     make_codes(node.right, current_code + "1", codes)
32
33
34 def build_huffman_tree(text):
35     """Build Huffman tree and return root + character codes."""
36     if not text:
37         return None, {}
38
39     # Step 1: Calculate frequency of each character
40     freq = {}
41     for ch in text:
42         freq[ch] = freq.get(ch, 0) + 1
43
44
45 # Step 2: Create a priority queue (min-heap) of nodes
46 heap = [Node(ch, fr) for ch, fr in freq.items()]
47 heapq.heapify(heap)
48
49 # Step 3: Build tree by merging two lowest-frequency nodes repeatedly
50 while len(heap) > 1:
51     n1 = heapq.heappop(heap) # Remove smallest node
52     n2 = heapq.heappop(heap) # Remove next smallest
53     merged = Node(None, n1.freq + n2.freq) # Create parent node
54     merged.left, merged.right = n1, n2 # Assign children
55     heapq.heappush(heap, merged) # Push merged node back into heap
56
57 # Step 4: Generate Huffman codes by traversing tree
58 root = heap[0]
59 codes = {}
60 make_codes(root, "", codes)
61 return root, codes
62
63 # ----- ENCODE AND DECODE -----
64 def huffman_encode(text, codes):
65     """Encode text using Huffman codes."""
66     return ''.join(codes[ch] for ch in text)
67
68
69 def huffman_decode(encoded_text, root):
70     """Decode encoded binary string using Huffman tree."""
71     decoded = ""
72     node = root
73     for bit in encoded_text:
74         node = node.left if bit == "0" else node.right
75         # If a leaf node is reached, append the character
76         if node.char is not None:
77             decoded += node.char
78             node = root # Restart from root for next symbol
79     return decoded
80
81
82 # ----- TKINTER GUI SETUP -----
83 root_win = Tk()
84 root_win.title(" Huffman Compression Tool")
85 root_win.geometry("600x520")
86
87
88 root_win.config(bg="#f5f6fa")
89 # Title Label
90 Label(root_win, text="Huffman Compression Tool", font=("Arial", 18, "bold"), bg="#f5f6fa", fg="#2f3640").pack(pady=10)
91
92 # Text area for displaying or typing input text
93 text_box = Text(root_win, width=70, height=10, wrap=WORD, font=("Arial", 11))
94 text_box.pack(pady=10)
95
96 # ----- INFORMATION LABELS -----
97 file_label = Label(root_win, text="No file loaded.", bg="#f5f6fa", fg="#353b48", font=("Arial", 10))
98 file_label.pack()
99
100 size_label = Label(root_win, text="", bg="#f5f6fa", fg="#273c75", font=("Arial", 10, "bold"))
101 size_label.pack(pady=5)
102
103 result_label = Label(root_win, text="", bg="#f5f6fa", fg="#944b42", font=("Arial", 11, "bold"))
104 result_label.pack(pady=5)
105
106 status_label = Label(root_win, text="", bg="#f5f6fa", fg="#00979b", font=("Arial", 11, "bold"))
107 status_label.pack(pady=5)
108
109 # ----- FILE & COMPRESSION FUNCTIONS -----
110 def load_file():
111     """Load a text file into the text box."""
112     global original_size, file_path
113     path = filedialog.askopenfilename(filetypes=[("Text Files", "*.txt")])
114     if path:
115         with open(path, "r", encoding="utf-8") as file:
116             data = file.read()
117             text_box.delete(1.0, END)
118             text_box.insert(END, data)
119             original_size = os.path.getsize(path)
120             file_path = path
121             file_label.config(text=f"Loaded File: {os.path.basename(path)}")
122             size_label.config(text=f"Original File Size: {original_size} bytes")
123             result_label.config(text="")
124             status_label.config(text="")
125             messagebox.showinfo("Loaded", f"Loaded: {os.path.basename(path)}")
126
127
128 def compress_text():
129     """Compress text using Huffman coding and save .bin file."""
130
131     global tree_root, codes, encoded_text, compressed_size
132     text = text_box.get(1.0, END).strip()
133     if not text:
134         messagebox.showwarning("Error", "Please enter or load some text!")
135         return
136
137     # Step 1: Build Huffman tree and generate codes
138     tree_root, codes = build_huffman_tree(text)
139     encoded_text = huffman_encode(text, codes)
140
141     # Step 2: Save compressed text to .bin file in same folder
142     if 'file_path' in globals():
143         folder = os.path.dirname(file_path)
144         base_name = os.path.splitext(os.path.basename(file_path))[0]
145         compressed_file_path = os.path.join(folder, f"{base_name}.compressed.bin")
146         with open(compressed_file_path, "w", encoding="utf-8") as comp_file:
147             comp_file.write(encoded_text)
148         messagebox.showinfo("File Saved", f"Compressed file saved as: {os.path.basename(compressed_file_path)}")
149     else:
150         messagebox.showwarning("Warning", "No original file loaded, compressed file not saved.")
151
152     # Step 3: Update text box and calculate compression ratio
153     text_box.delete(1.0, END)
154     text_box.insert(END, text)
155
156     original_bits = len(text.encode("utf-8")) * 8
157     compressed_bits = len(encoded_text)
158     compressed_size = compressed_bits / 8 # Convert bits to bytes
159     ratio = (compressed_size / (original_bits / 8)) * 100
160
161     result_label.config(
162         text=f"File: {os.path.basename(file_path)}\nCompressed Size: {int(compressed_size)} bytes | Compression Ratio: {ratio:.2f}%"
163     )
164     status_label.config(text="Compression Done Successfully!")
165
166
167 def decompress_text():
168     """Decompress the encoded text and restore the original content."""
169     global encoded_text
170     if 'encoded_text' not in globals() or not encoded_text:
171         messagebox.showwarning("Error", "No compressed data available for decompression!")
172         return
```

```

172
173
174     decoded = huffman.decode(encoded_text, tree_root)
175     text_box.delete(1.0, END)
176     text_box.insert(END, decoded)
177     status_label.config(text="Decompression Done Successfully!")
178
179     # Save decompressed text back to a file
180     if 'file_path' in globals():
181         folder = os.path.dirname(file_path)
182         base_name = os.path.splitext(os.path.basename(file_path))[0]
183         decompressed_path = os.path.join(folder, f'{base_name}_decompressed.txt')
184         with open(decompressed_path, "w", encoding="utf-8") as dec_file:
185             dec_file.write(decoded)
186         messagebox.showinfo("File Saved", f"Decompressed file saved as:\n(decompressed_path)")
187     else:
188         messagebox.showwarning("Warning", "No original file loaded, decompressed file not saved.")
189
190 except Exception as e:
191     messagebox.showerror("Error", f"Invalid compressed data!\n(e)")
192
193
194 def show_codes():
195     """Display generated Huffman codes in a new window."""
196     if 'codes' not in globals() or not codes:
197         messagebox.showwarning("Info", "No codes generated yet!")
198         return
199     code_win = Toplevel(root_win)
200     code_win.title("Huffman Codes")
201     code_win.config(bg="white")
202     Label(code_win, text="Character : Code", font=("Arial", 12, "bold"), bg="white").pack(pady=5)
203     for ch, code in codes.items():
204         Label(code_win, text=f"{ch} : {code}", bg="white", font=("Arial", 11)).pack(anchor="w")
205
206
207 def view_bits():
208     """Preview first 1000 bits of the compressed binary text."""
209     if 'encoded_text' not in globals() or not encoded_text:
210         messagebox.showwarning("Warning", "Cannot view bits before compression!")
211         return
212
213     bit_win = Toplevel(root_win)
214     bit_win.title("Compressed Bits Preview")

```

```

212
213     bit_win = Toplevel(root_win)
214     bit_win.title("Compressed Bits Preview")
215     bit_win.config(bg="white")
216     Label(bit_win, text="Compressed Bits Preview", font=("Arial", 12, "bold"), bg="white").pack(pady=5)
217
218     preview = encoded_text[:1000] + ("..." if len(encoded_text) > 1000 else "")
219     text_area = Text(bit_win, wrap=WORD, width=80, height=20, font=("Consolas", 10))
220     text_area.insert(END, preview)
221     text_area.pack(padx=10, pady=10)
222
223
224 # ----- GUI BUTTONS -----
225 Button(root_win, text="Load File", width=15, command=load_file, bg="#00a8ff", fg="white",
226         font=("Arial", 10, "bold")).pack(pady=5)
227 Button(root_win, text="Compress", width=15, command=compress_text, bg="#44bd32", fg="white",
228         font=("Arial", 10, "bold")).pack(pady=5)
229 Button(root_win, text="Decompress", width=15, command=decompress_text, bg="#e1b12c", fg="white",
230         font=("Arial", 10, "bold")).pack(pady=5)
231 Button(root_win, text="View Bits", width=15, command=view_bits, bg="#9b59b6", fg="white",
232         font=("Arial", 10, "bold")).pack(pady=5)
233 Button(root_win, text="View Huffman Codes", width=20, command=show_codes, bg="#8c7ae6", fg="white",
234         font=("Arial", 10, "bold")).pack(pady=5)
235
236 # ----- RUN MAIN GUI LOOP -----
237 root_win.mainloop()
238

```

### **The Extent of Compression Achieved With the Tool:**

| <b>Input File Type</b>               | <b>Description</b>                                                     | <b>Original Size</b> | <b>Compressed Size</b> | <b>Compression Ratio</b> | <b>Compression percentage</b> |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|
| File 1 – Repetitive Characters       | Text with artificially repeated letters like “paaaaraaagraph”          | 520 Bytes            | 262 Bytes              | 1.99:1                   | 50.50%                        |
| File 2 – ASCII Symbols File          | Mixed ASCII symbols (@#\$%^&()[]{}<>?/), reducing predictable patterns | 591 Bytes            | 345 Bytes              | 1.71:1                   | 58.50%                        |
| File 3 – Climate Change English Text | Normal natural-language paragraph with medium repetition               | 2244 Bytes           | 1199 Bytes             | 1.87:1                   | 58.37%                        |

### **Sample Compression Results Using Our Huffman Tool**

#### **Test Case 1 – File 1 (Repetitive Characters Paragraph)**

- Original size: 520 Bytes
- Compressed size: 262 Bytes

#### **Compression Ratio:**

Compression Ratio = Original Size / Compressed Size

$$= 520 / 262$$

$$\approx 1.99 : 1$$

- This file compresses well because repeated characters create highly skewed frequency distributions

#### **Test Case 2 – File 2 (ASCII Symbols File)**

- Original size: 591 Bytes
- Compressed size: 345 Bytes

#### **Compression Ratio**

Compression Ratio = Original Size / Compressed Size

$$= 591 / 345$$

$$\approx 1.71 : 1$$

- ASCII-heavy files compress moderately because symbols occur with relatively uniform frequency.

### Test Case 3 – File 3 (Climate Change English Text):

- Original size: 2,244 Bytes
- Compressed size: 1,199 Bytes

#### Compression Ratio:

Compression Ratio = Original Size / Compressed Size

$$= 2244 / 1199$$

$$\approx 1.87 : 1$$

- Normal English text contains natural patterns → produces solid, moderate compression.

#### Factors Affecting Compression:

- **File 1 – Repetitive Characters:** Extremely uneven frequency → high compression.
- **File 2 – ASCII Symbols:** Many different characters → frequency spread out → moderate compression.
- **File 3 – Climate Change Text:** Balanced English vocabulary → moderate compression.

#### How Our Code Calculates Compression

```
original_bits = len(text.encode("utf-8")) * 8
```

```
compressed_bits = len(encoded_text)
```

```
compressed_size = compressed_bits / 8
```

```
ratio = (compressed_size / (original_bits / 8)) * 100
```

#### Explanation:

- original\_bits → size of the text in bits before compression
- compressed\_bits → size of Huffman encoded text in bits
- compressed\_size → compressed size in bytes
- ratio → percentage of original size remaining after compression

#### Formulae Used

##### Compression Ratio

Compression Ratio = Original Size / Compressed Size

$$= \text{Original Size} / \text{Compressed Size}$$

$$\approx (\text{calculated value})$$

##### Compression Percentage

Compression Percentage = (Compressed Size / Original Size) × 100

$$= (\text{Compressed Size} / \text{Original Size}) \times 100$$

$$\approx (\text{calculated value})$$

## **Time and Space Complexity of the Compression Algorithm:**

### **1. Complexity of the Huffman Coding Algorithm**

#### **(a) Frequency Counting**

for ch in text:

    freq[ch] = freq.get(ch, 0) + 1

- Each character is processed once.
- Time Complexity:  $O(n)$
- Space Complexity:  $O(k)$ , where  $k$  = number of distinct character

#### **(b) Building the Min-Heap**

heap = [Node(ch, fr) for ch, fr in freq.items()]

heapq.heapify(heap)

- Creating the list:  $O(k)$
- Heapify operation:  $O(k)$
- Time Complexity:  $O(k)$
- Space Complexity:  $O(k)$

#### **(c) Building the Huffman Tree**

while len(heap) > 1:

    n1 = heapq.heappop(heap)

    n2 = heapq.heappop(heap)

    merged = Node(None, n1.freq + n2.freq)

    merged.left, merged.right = n1, n2

    heapq.heappush(heap, merged)

- Each pop/push operation:  $O(\log k)$
- Number of merges:  $k-1$
- Time Complexity:  $O(k \log k)$
- Space Complexity:  $O(k)$  for tree nodes

#### **(d) Generating Huffman Codes (Traversal)**

make\_codes(root, "", codes)

- Traverses all  $k$  nodes in the tree
- Time Complexity:  $O(k)$
- Space Complexity:  $O(k)$

#### **(e) Encoding the Text**

encoded\_text = "".join(codes[ch] for ch in text)

- Each character is replaced with its Huffman code
- Time Complexity:  $O(n)$
- Space Complexity:  $O(n)$  for the encoded string



## Overall Huffman Algorithm Complexity

| STEP            | TIME COMPLEXITY   | SPACE COMPLEXITY |
|-----------------|-------------------|------------------|
| Frequency count | $O(n)$            | $O(k)$           |
| Heap building   | $O(k)$            | $O(k)$           |
| Tree building   | $O(k \log k)$     | $O(k)$           |
| Code generation | $O(k)$            | $O(k)$           |
| Encoding        | $O(n)$            | $O(n)$           |
| Total           | $O(n + k \log k)$ | $O(n+k)$         |

Since  $k$  (number of unique characters) is typically small compared to  $n$ , the dominant cost is  $O(n)$ .

## 2. Complexity of the Full GUI Code

- GUI and file operations add practical but not asymptotic complexity:
  - Loading file:  $O(n)$
  - Writing compressed/decompressed file:  $O(n)$
  - Tkinter GUI operations:  $O(1)$  (negligible)

**Time Complexity:**  $O(n + k \log k)$

**Space Complexity:**  $O(n + k)$

## 3. Decompression Complexity

for bit in encoded\_text:

node = node.left if bit == "0" else node.right

if node.char is not None:

decoded += node.char

node = root

- Each bit is processed once
- **Time Complexity:**  $O(m)$ , where  $m$  = length of encoded bitstring
- **Space Complexity:**  $O(n)$  for decoded text

Since  $m \approx n \times \text{average\_code\_length} \leq n \times \log(k)$ , approximate time complexity:  $O(n)$

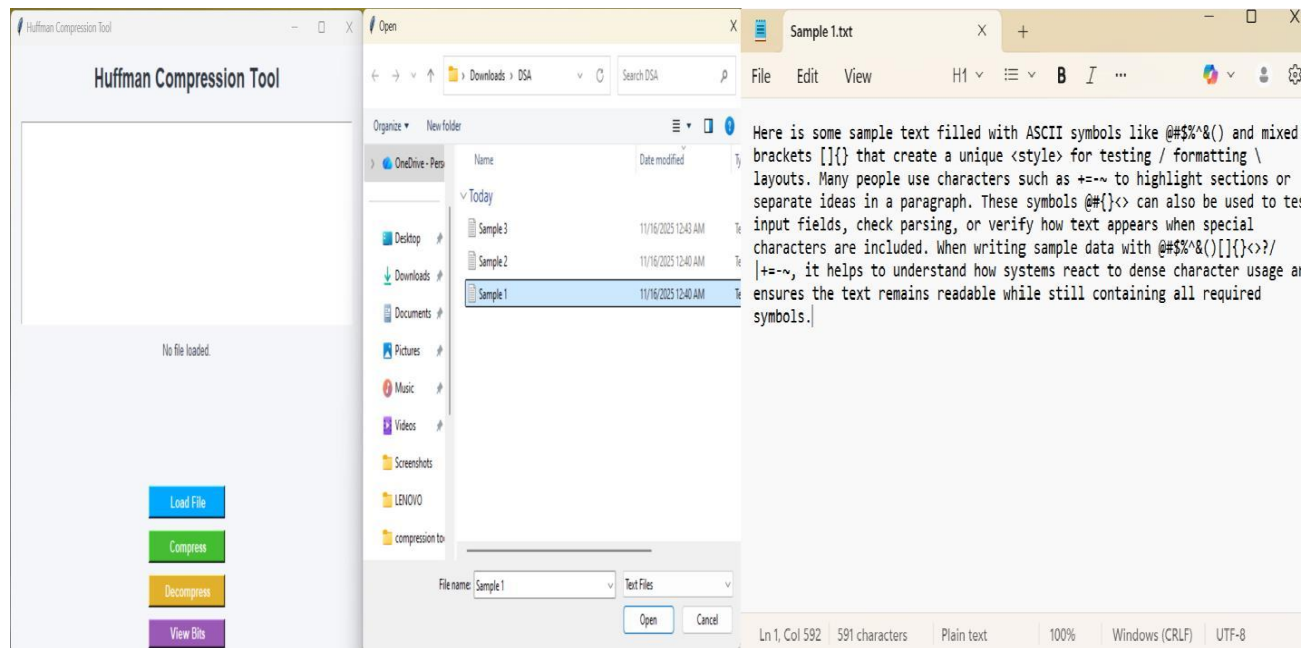
#### 4. Summary Table

| OPERATION                             | TIME COMPLEXITY   | SPACE COMPLEXITY |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------|
| Build frequency map                   | $O(n)$            | $O(k)$           |
| Build Huffman tree                    | $O(k \log k)$     | $O(k)$           |
| Encode text                           | $O(n)$            | $O(n)$           |
| Decode text                           | $O(n)$            | $O(n)$           |
| Overall (Compression + Decompression) | $O(n + k \log k)$ | $O(n + k)$       |

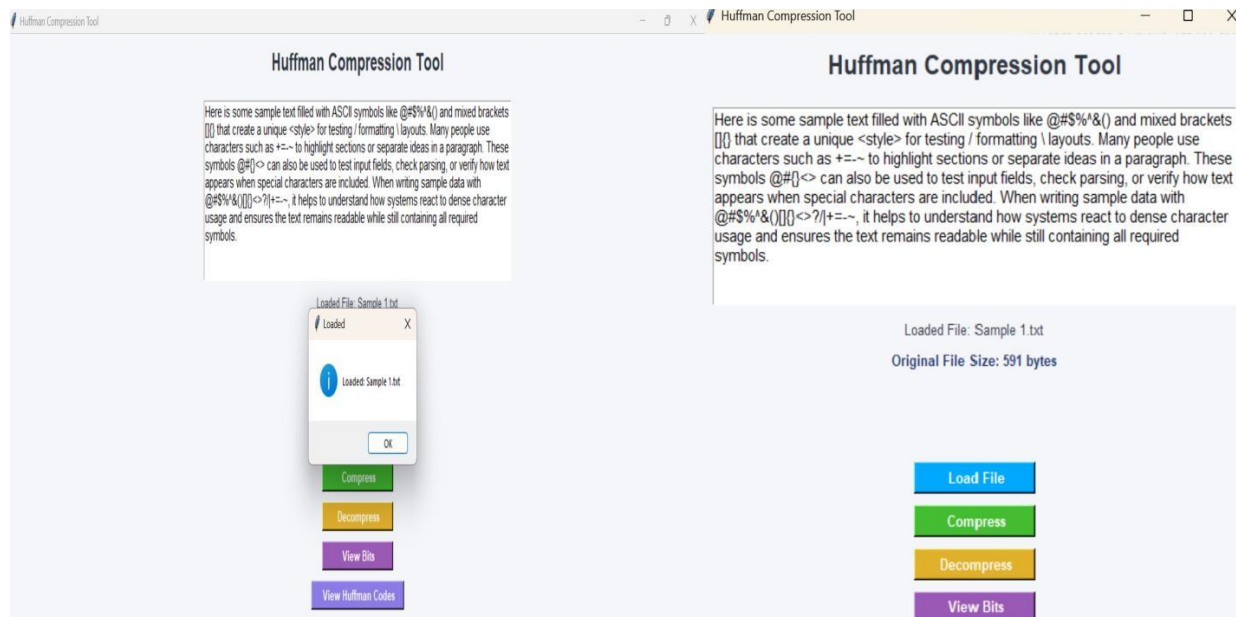
#### 5. Conclusion:

The implementation of Huffman Coding effectively demonstrates a robust method for lossless data compression. By assigning shorter codes to frequently occurring characters and longer codes to less frequent ones, the algorithm optimizes storage and reduces data size for text-based information. The results indicate that the efficiency of Huffman coding largely depends on the frequency distribution and redundancy present in the input data, highlighting its suitability for datasets with repetitive patterns.

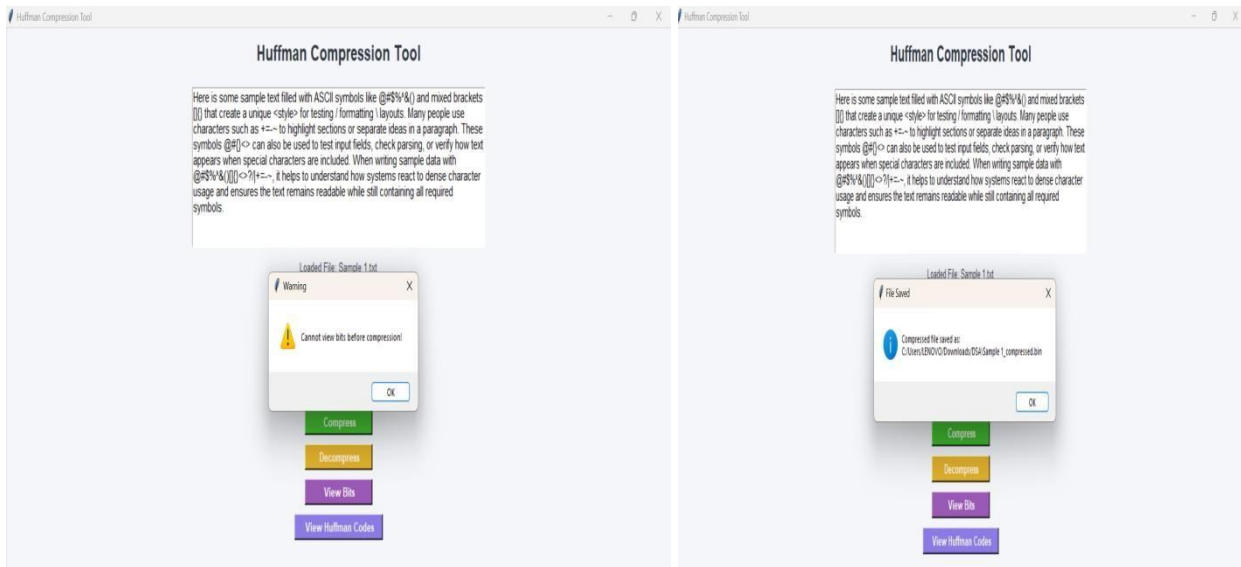
## Sample Input and Output Files:



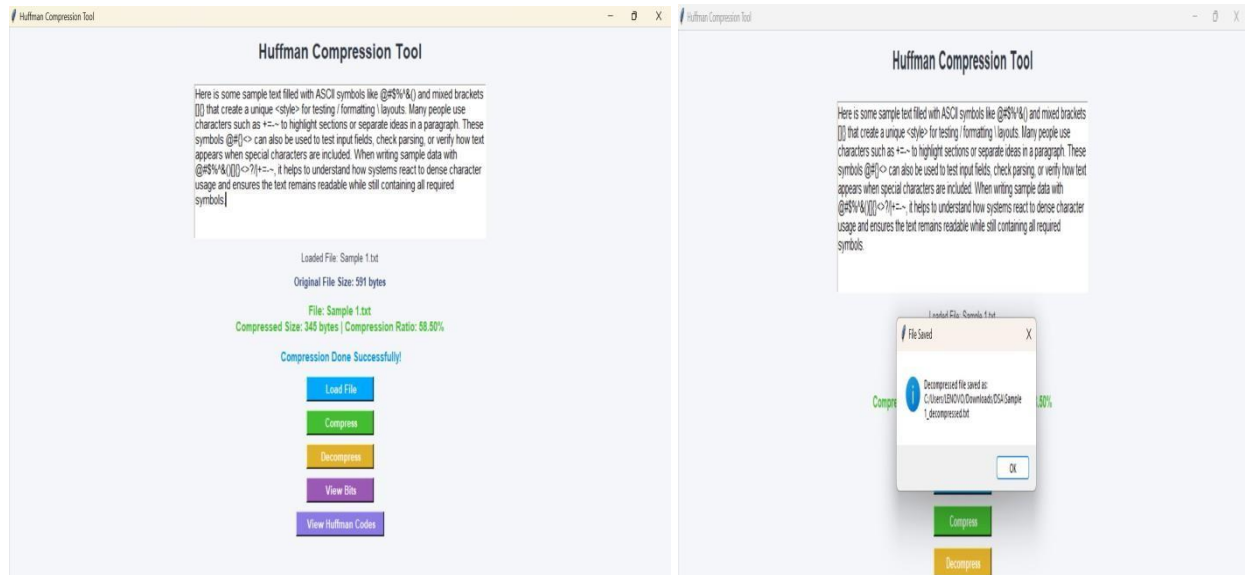
## GUI Interface - Main Application Window



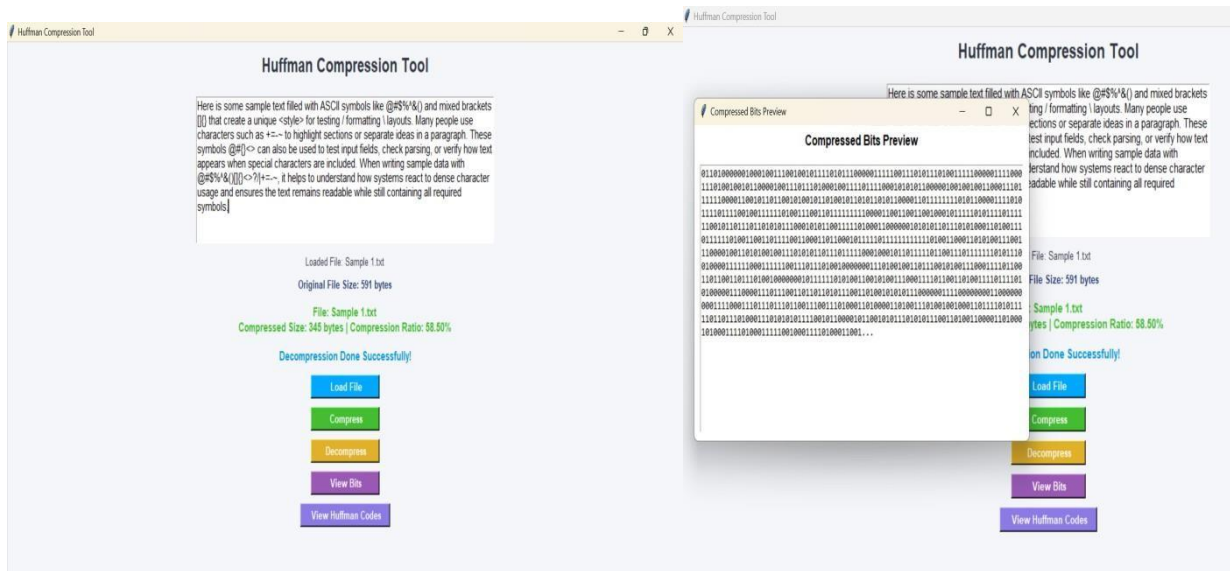
## Loading A file And Showing Original Size Of A File



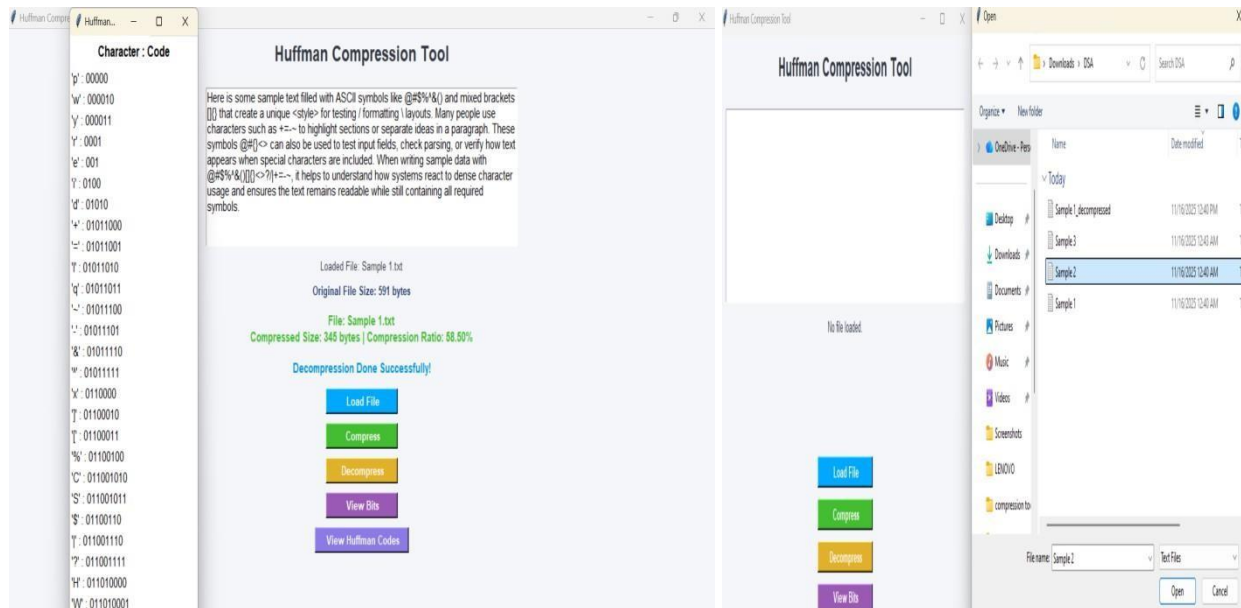
**Displays a pre-compression warning when viewing bits and shows the saved file path.**



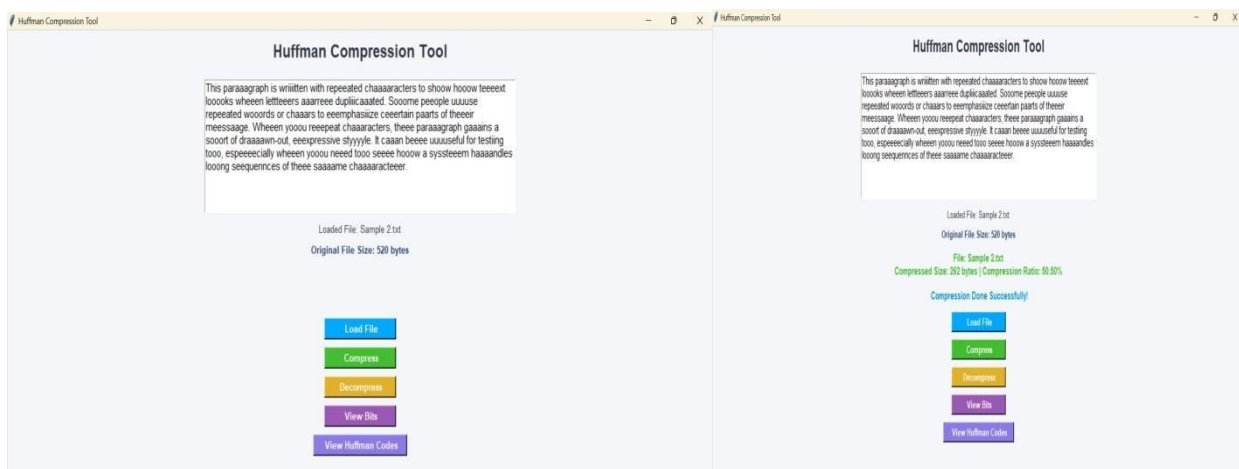
**Input file: Original Text with ASCII Symbols with its compression and decompression**



## Compressed Bits Preview



## Huffman Codes



## Input file: Repetitive or distorted file and it's compression

### Huffman Compression Tool

Climate change is one of the most pressing issues facing humanity today. It refers to long-term changes in global temperature, precipitation, and weather patterns. The main cause of climate change is the excessive release of greenhouse gases, such as carbon dioxide and methane. These gases trap heat in the Earth's atmosphere, leading to a rise in global temperatures. Industrialization, deforestation, and the burning of fossil fuels have accelerated this process. As a result, glaciers are melting, sea levels are rising, and extreme weather events are occurring more frequently.

Loaded File: Sample 2.txt  
Original File Size: 1844 bytes

Load File  
Compress  
Decompress  
View Bits  
View Huffman Codes

### Huffman Compression Tool

Climate change is one of the most pressing issues facing humanity today. It refers to long-term changes in global temperature, precipitation, and weather patterns. The main cause of climate change is the excessive release of greenhouse gases, such as carbon dioxide and methane. These gases trap heat in the Earth's atmosphere, leading to a rise in global temperatures. Industrialization, deforestation, and the burning of fossil fuels have accelerated this process. As a result, glaciers are melting, sea levels are rising, and extreme weather events are occurring more frequently.

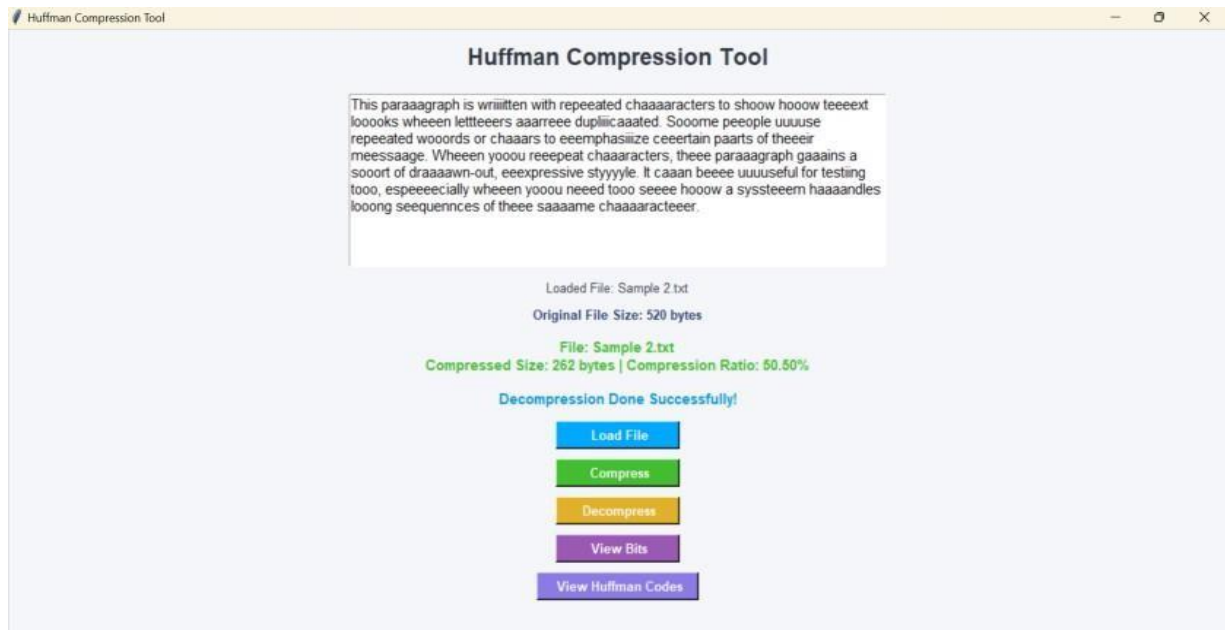
Loaded File: Sample 2.txt  
Original File Size: 1844 bytes

File: Sample 2.txt  
Compressed Size: 996 bytes | Compression Ratio: 54.60%

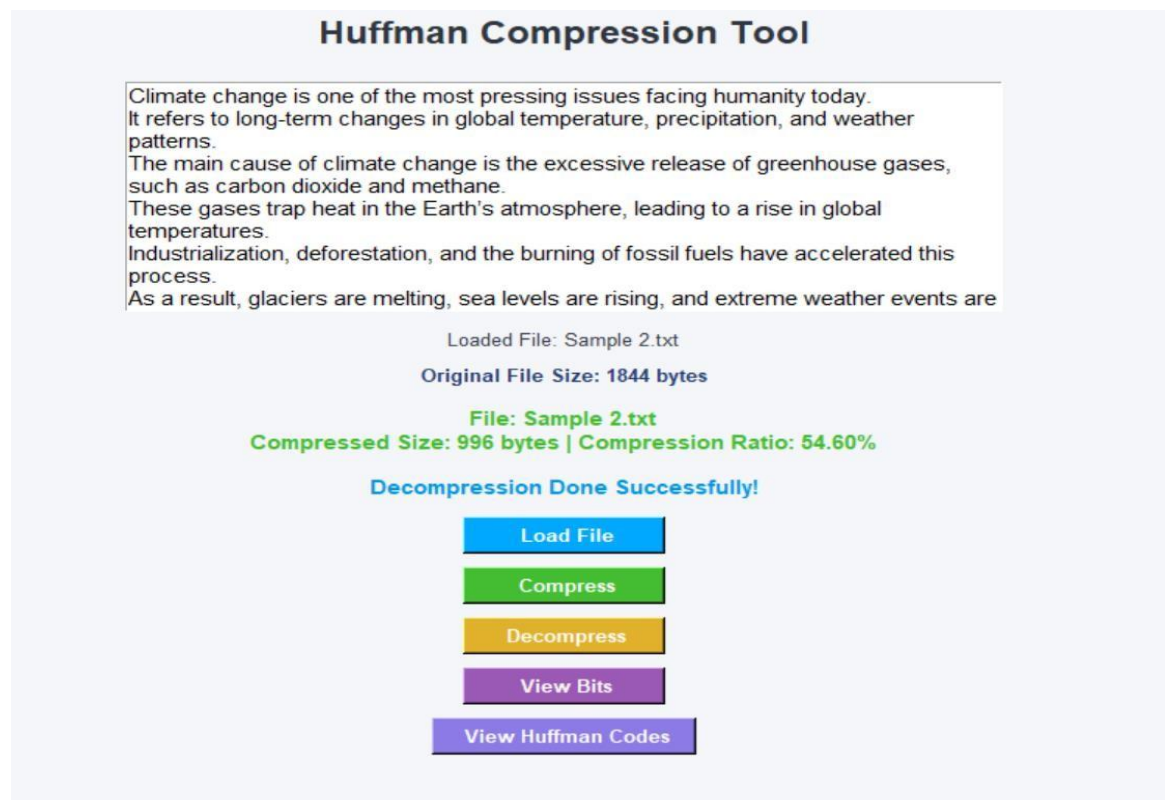
Compression Done Successfully!

Load File  
Compress  
Decompress  
View Bits  
View Huffman Codes

## Input file: English Text File( Climate Change) And It's Compression



## Decompression Of A Input Repetitive file



## Decompression Of A Input English Text File (Climate Change)